Northgate Community Food Bank AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: CEO, until the board names an owner · Next review: in 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take routine writing off our plate, while protecting the people who trust us and keeping real people helping them.

Who it covers. Staff, volunteers, contractors and board members. Whether volunteers may use AI tools is still open.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Gemini (Google Workspace):** Drafting through your work account. Approved for no protected information.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Ken (IT) approves any new tool, plugin, agent or AI feature in existing software. He checks what data it sees and whether the vendor trains on it.
- **Accounts.** Use your Northgate work account. Turn off any setting that lets the vendor train on what you type.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- **Everyone, now.** Staff may use Gemini through their work Google account for work with no information about a real person in it.
- Draft volunteer newsletters and social posts.
- Draft volunteer thank-you notes; add names yourself afterward.
- Draft standard grant boilerplate, with no figures.

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- AI use for SNAP outreach or donor work, even with no personal details — *Marcus (CEO)*
- Food recall or allergen information — *Your manager*
- Reports to Feeding America or funders — *Your manager*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: Passwords and login details. SNAP outreach records: Social Security numbers, income, household members, immigration documents (state human services agreement). Donor records in Salesforce. Volunteer names, phone numbers, emergency contacts, court-ordered service case details. Mobile pantry sign-ups with names and zip codes.
- No AI chatbot answers eligibility questions or replaces SNAP staff.
- No AI-made images of hungry people. Our photos are real, with consent.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- You check facts, names, numbers and tone. Whoever sends it is responsible for it.
- Pounds and people served come from the inventory system, never AI. Check recalls against the original notice.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides who gets food, SNAP help or a volunteer role. A person decides.
- Trained, certified outreach staff answer all eligibility questions.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- If asked, we say honestly how we use AI. SNAP line callers always reach a person.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell your manager and Ken the same day.
- Reporting a mistake is expected. No one is punished for it.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- Owner: CEO, until the board names one.
- The board's executive committee approves the policy.
- We share it with all staff and volunteers. We review it in 12 months.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Do we pay for or approve ChatGPT and Claude, which some staff use on their own? Is that in next year's budget?
- May volunteers, such as group leaders writing shift notes, use AI? With which tools?
- Do AI reminder texts in our scheduling software stay on? Do we tell volunteers?
- Who approves using a partner's logo or brand with AI, given one partnership agreement's AI clause?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.